University of St.Gallen

Guideline Bachelor's Thesis in Economics (R25)

It is worth reading this information carefully before starting the Bachelor's Thesis! This guide is for informational purposes only and is not legally binding.

- The **Bachelor's Thesis in Economics** is an individual academic project valued with **12 ECTS** credits. The Thesis should have an **Economic reference** and can be credited to a specialisation. An ECTS is estimated to take approximately 30 hours of work and can be written in **English or German**.
- The **Thesis Preparation Colloquium** is compulsory for students enrolled in the study regulation curriculumR25. A **defense** of the Bachelor's Thesis is not required.
- The Colloquium is **taking place on Campus** and it is not possible to attend the Colloquium online.
- Students, enrolled in an exchange semester can bid for the Colloquium **but have to make sure and are self-responsble to be on Campus** on the respective dates. Students have to contact the Programme Management upon the Bidding start so that they can be enrolled manually to the Colloquium.
- The Colloquium **cannot be bidded** during the Waiting List rounds.
- Comprehensive and legal information on the Bachelor's Thesis process is available on StudentWeb. All important information is listed in the legal foundations, specifically in the Implementation Provisions Academic Programmes in Art. 54 to Art. 67 and in the Directives of the Dean of Studies (Chapter 5).
- Specific information for the Major Economics can be found on StudentWeb Major Economics and the respective FAQs.

Topics

- **You are responsible for coming up with an own topic**. Also, you will **need to find a supervisor** on your own.
- The **topic** of the Bachelor's Thesis **should be related** to one or more subject areas of the Economics programme.
- If the person, who is to supervise the Bachelor's Thesis, is **not a member of the Department Economics at SEPS**, including external lecturers, the consent of the Economics Programme Management must be obtained in advance. A list of persons authorized to supervise is available on StudentWeb. This list is refreshed at the start of each semester but does not include external lecturers.
- A **list of Faculty Members of the Economics Department and** their research areas is provided on StudentWeb Major Economics.
- **Tips**: What topics are you interested in? / Is there a supervisor who is doing research on this (check StudentWeb) and who is familiar with you through previous coursework?
- Should you encounter difficulties in finding a supervisor, you may seek additional assistance from the Programme Management (majorvwl@unisg.ch).

Before Registration

- **Thesis Preparation Colloquium**: The Thesis Preparation Colloquium has to be completed before submitting the Thesis Registration Form.
- **Initial Discussion**: It's crucial to have a preliminary meeting with your chosen supervisor to discuss your Thesis topic. Depending on your supervisor, you might also be required to draft an initial exposé.
- **Supervision:** You must seek approval from the Programme Management before registering the Thesis. Please send your request for approval to majorvwl@unisg.ch.
- **Specialisation Credit**: If you're aiming to have your Thesis credited towards a specialisation, you need to submit a brief outline for approval to the Programme Management at majorvwl@unisg.ch before registration. This outline should state your intended (i) research question, (ii) methodology, (iii) data sources.

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Registration

- **Registration**: Since 17th February 2025 the Bachelor's Theses have to be registered via the new Thesis Management Platform via «My Thesis».
- The Programme-specific instructions are provided on the programme StudentWeb-pages. Please read the given information carefully.
- **Registration Deadlines:** With the new process, there are no longer any registration periods. The correct and timely registration is the responsibility of the students. On StudentWeb and in the document "Deadlines" will you find further information.
- **Confirmation**: The registration will automatically be forwarded to the assigned supervisor for approval. With the approval of the programme, the registration is binding and a confirmation with the last possible submission deadline will be sent via email
- **Thesis Completion Timeline:** Once the registration window closes, you have 12 months to write and submit your Bachelor's Thesis.

Thesis Completion Phase

- **Semester Enrolment:** Throughout the entire Thesis writing phase until the official submission of the Bachelor's Thesis, a valid semester enrolment at the corresponding academic level is required. If you are not attending any more courses or taking exams, you may apply for a semester leave for the writing process via Compass. More information is available on StudentWeb.
- **Formal Requirements:** A guideline for the length of the Bachelor's Thesis in the Major Economics R25 is a maximum of 50 pages (approx. 85,000 characters). A font size of 12 (Times New Roman) or 11 (Arial) or equivalent fonts, with a line spacing of 1.5 is the general recommendation. Please see the Implementation Regulations for the Examination Regulations for the Bachelor's and Master's Level, Art. 54 – Art. 65. Detailed information on the layout of a Bachelor"s Thesis can be found in the Directives of the Dean of Studies (Chapter 5) and on StudentWeb Major Economics.
- **Communication:** Communicate with your supervisor to understand the specific requirements and expectations for your Thesis.

Submission

- **Submission Deadlines**: As soon as you have received the registration confirmation via E-Mail, the Thesis can be submitted. The latest submission deadline is defined on the confirmation, but the Thesis can also be submitted for any earlier dates.
- **Submission via Thesis Management Platform:** The Bachelor's Thesis must be submitted electronically via the Thesis Management Platform.

Report/Grade/Graduation

- **Grading Timeline:** The grade for the Bachelor's Thesis will be issued 3 months after the submission period closes. After that, you have the possibility to obtain **feedback** on your Thesis, including the main comments from the report.
- **Passing Grade**: A minimum grade of 4.0 is required to pass the Bachelor's Thesis. If the grade falls below this threshold, the Bachelor's programme is considered as failed. Students may have the opportunity for a second attempt by writing a new Thesis on a different topic.
- The title B.A. (Bachelor of Arts) may be used from the day of the graduation.

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! This guide is not legally binding. The regulations and directives referred to, apply and are always available in their latest version among the University's decrees.

Contact



Further information ion topics, supervisor etc.

Programme Management Major Economics
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to all administrative questions (registration, deadlines submission etc.)

Dean's Advisory Office
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